

Corporate Employee Travel & Business Expense Policy

Finance & People Operations - Governance Document Ref: POL-TRV-2026-V3

1.1 Purpose and Guiding Principles

This Corporate Travel and Expense Policy establishes standardized guidelines for all full-time employees, contractors, and executive staff traveling on approved company business. The policy balances business necessity, traveler comfort, and fiscal responsibility. All travel expenditures must be reasonable, necessary, appropriately documented, and incurred strictly for legitimate corporate purposes. Employees are expected to treat company capital with the same prudence as personal funds.

1.2 Mandatory Travel Booking Portal and Advance Notice

All commercial airline flights, railway journeys, and hotel reservations must be booked exclusively through the corporate travel management system (SAP Concur). Reservations must be finalized at least fourteen (14) calendar days prior to the scheduled departure date to capture lowest logical corporate airfares. Bookings made fewer than 14 days in advance require formal email pre-approval from the employee's designated Department Vice President (VP), documenting the specific customer emergency or unanticipated commercial justification.

1.3 Air Travel: Permitted Classes of Service

Economy / Coach Class: Standard commercial economy class is mandatory for all domestic flights, continental transits, and short-haul international flights having a scheduled flight duration under eight (8) continuous hours. Employees may purchase seat selection or extra legroom seats if under \$60 each way. Premium Economy Class: Permitted for international flights exceeding six (6) continuous flight hours with written approval from the traveler's Senior Director. Business Class: Strictly restricted to non-stop transoceanic international flights with continuous scheduled flight duration exceeding eight (8) hours, or multi-leg international journeys with scheduled flight time exceeding 12 aggregate hours. Prior written authorization from the executive Vice President (VP) is mandatory. First Class: First class air travel is strictly prohibited under all circumstances across all personnel levels, including executive officers.

1.4 Flight Changes, Baggage, and Frequent Flyer Points

The company reimburses standard fees for up to one (1) checked bag for trips under 5 days, and up to two (2) checked bags for trips exceeding 5 days. Employees are entitled to accrue and retain airline frequent flyer miles and hotel loyalty points for personal usage, provided participation incurs zero additional cost.

Corporate Travel Policy (Lodging & Meal Allowances)

2.1 Hotel Accommodations and Nightly Ceilings

Hotel accommodations must be standard single occupancy rooms booked at preferred corporate chain properties (Marriott, Hyatt, Hilton, or IHG). Nightly room rate caps are established based on metropolitan economic tiers (excluding mandatory state and municipal occupancy taxes): Tier 1 High-Cost Metro Areas: The maximum reimbursable nightly rate is capped at \$250.00 USD per night. Tier 1 cities include: New York City, San Francisco Bay Area, Boston, London, Paris, Tokyo, Singapore, and Zurich. Tier 2 Standard Metro Areas: For all standard metropolitan regions and provincial destinations, the lodging ceiling is capped at \$175.00 USD per night. In-room video entertainment, minibar consumption, laundry for trips under 5 days, and spa charges are strictly non-reimbursable.

2.2 Daily Meal Allowances (Per Diem Rates)

Employees traveling on overnight business are allocated a total daily meal per diem ceiling of \$75.00 USD. The daily allowance is broken down into meal allocations: Breakfast: \$15.00 USD; Lunch: \$25.00 USD; Dinner: \$35.00 USD. If breakfast is provided by the hotel or conference, the allowable per diem is reduced by \$15.00. Itemized receipts showing breakdown of food and beverages are mandatory for all expense line items exceeding \$25.00 USD. Non-itemized credit card transaction slips alone are unacceptable under corporate audit guidelines.

2.3 Alcoholic Beverages and Client Entertainment Protocol

Alcoholic beverages consumed during individual travel meals are strictly non-reimbursable and must be paid with personal funds. Exception for Business Client Entertainment: Alcoholic drinks may be expensed only during official business client entertainment dinners where external clients or sales prospects are present. Such meals require prior written authorization from a Senior Director and must include a detailed receipt noting all attendees, business affiliations, and commercial discussion topics.

Corporate Travel Policy (Ground Transit & Medical SOS)

3.1 Ground Transportation Guidelines

Employees are encouraged to utilize public transit (subway, express airport rail) or corporate rideshare accounts (Uber for Business / Lyft Pink). Personal rideshare journeys must be charged to the corporate profile and categorized with project codes. Rental Automobiles: Car rental is permitted only when public transit or rideshare is demonstrably impractical or cost-prohibitive. Rental reservations must be limited to Compact or Intermediate Sedan classes. Full-size, SUV, luxury, sports cars, and convertibles are strictly forbidden. Rental collision damage waiver (CDW) insurance should be waived domestically because the company maintains blanket corporate umbrella coverage.

3.2 International Emergency Travel Health Insurance

All full-time personnel traveling internationally on approved company business are automatically enrolled in the corporate global emergency insurance plan. Underwritten by Allianz Global Assistance, the policy covers medical emergencies, acute illness, emergency hospitalization, prescription drug coverage, and medical trauma air evacuation up to \$1,000,000 USD per incident. Master Corporate Policy Reference Number: GLOBAL-SEC-88421. Group Plan Code: ALLIANZ-CORP-MED-99.

3.3 24/7 Emergency Assistance Hotline and SOS Procedures

In the event of a medical crisis, political evacuation, natural disaster, or lost passport/documentation abroad: 1. Contact the 24/7 dedicated Allianz Global Assistance SOS hotline immediately at +1-800-555-0199 (North America toll-free) or direct international collect line at +1-415-555-0288. 2. Send an email alert with location coordinates to the Global Security Operations Center (GSOC) at gsoc-emergency@company.com and dispatch-sos@allianz-travel-safe.com. 3. Notify the Corporate HR Benefits Director within twenty-four (24) hours of the incident.